



Rounded edges

Varied tones
and colours

Visible inclusions

Settings

Amber necklace | This substantial necklace is composed of elongated, polished beads in a fan pattern, and features many small inclusions. Amber's light weight makes it suitable for use in large jewellery pieces such as this.

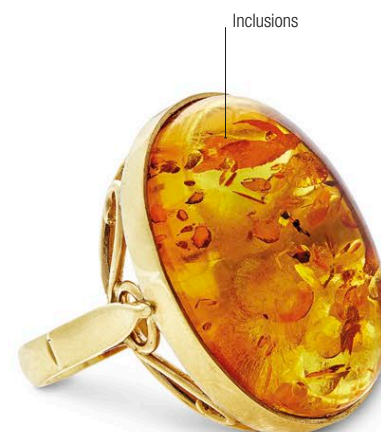
Amber
cabochon

Aquatic pendant | Featuring an amber cabochon set in silver, this German pendant from around 1930 was made by Louis Vausch, who was known for his use of fish motifs.



Silver frame

Earrings | These two teardrop-shaped amber cabochons with inclusions have been framed in silver and suspended in a pair of dangle earrings.



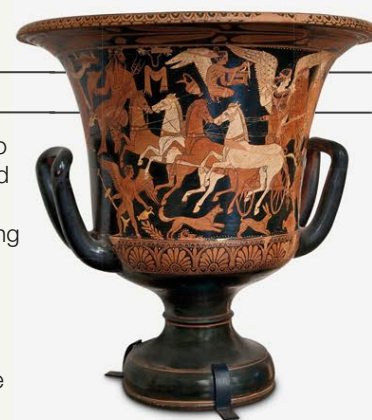
Inclusions

Amber ring | The centrepiece of this silver ring is a fine piece of gem amber, showing numerous trapped air bubbles and inclusions of organic matter.

Grieving gods

Amber's mythological past

The ancient Greeks made reference to amber in one of their myths. Demi-god Phaethon lost control while driving his sun-god father's fiery chariot, scorching the Earth's surface. To stop him, Zeus struck him dead with a thunderbolt, causing his body to fall into a river. The river's nymphs buried Phaethon's body on the shore, and his sisters, the three Heliades, wept over it night and day. Eventually, their grieving bodies took root as trees, and their tears hardened into droplets of amber.



Phaethon in Apollo's chariot
This Greek vase depicts the story of Phaethon and the Heliades.